Project Planning Phase

Product Backlog, Sprint Planning, Stories & Story Points

Date	04 April 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-2136
Project Name	Automating Employee Data
Maximum Marks	5 Marks

Product Backlog, Sprint Schedule & Estimation (4 Marks)

The product backlog below captures all user stories across 4 sprints for the Automating Employee Data project. Each story is estimated in story points using Fibonacci-based planning poker, with priorities assigned based on business value and dependency.

Sprint	Epic	User Story #	User Story / Task	Story Points	Priority	Team Member
Sprint-1	Data Preparation	**USN-01**	As an HR administrator, I can prepare an employee data file (Excel/CSV/XML) containing Name, Email, Department, Manager, and Manager's Email so that it can be loaded into ServiceNow.	**2**	**High**	HR Admin
Sprint-1	Data Preparation	**USN-02**	As an HR administrator, I can validate the employee data file for missing fields, duplicate emails, and formatting errors before importing, so that the import succeeds without errors.	**2**	**High**	HR Admin
Sprint-1	Import Sets	**USN-03**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can upload the employee data file via Import Sets (System Import Sets > Load Data) so that the data is ingested into a staging table.	**3**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-1	Import Sets	**USN-04**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can create a staging table (u_employee_import) during the import so that incoming employee records are held for validation before transformation.	**2**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-1	Import Sets	**USN-05**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can review the Import Set Run Log to verify row counts and identify import errors so	**2**	**High**	SN Admin

			that data quality is confirmed before executing the transform.			
Sprint-2	Transform Map	**USN-06**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can create a Transform Map that maps staging table fields (Name, Email, Department) to corresponding sys_user table fields so that employee records are correctly populated.	**3**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-2	Transform Map	**USN-07**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can configure the Manager field mapping in the Transform Map as a reference lookup to sys_user so that manager hierarchy is correctly resolved during transformation.	**3**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-2	Transform Map	**USN-08**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can set a Coalesce rule on the Email field in the Transform Map so that re-running the import does not create duplicate user records.	**2**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-2	Transform Map	**USN-09**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can execute the Transform Map and validate that employee records are correctly inserted or updated in the sys_user table with accurate field values.	**3**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-3	Incident Form Config	**USN-10**	As a ServiceNow developer, I can configure the Incident form to display the Assigned To user's Department using dot walking (assigned_to.department) so that resolvers see department context without additional clicks.	**2**	**High**	Developer
Sprint-3	Incident Form Config	**USN-11**	As a ServiceNow developer, I can add the Assigned To user's Email to the Incident form via dot walking (assigned_to.email) so that contact information is immediately visible to incident managers.	**2**	**Medium**	Developer
Sprint-3	Incident Form Config	**USN-12**	As a ServiceNow developer, I can add the Assigned To user's Manager to the Incident form via dot walking (assigned_to.manager) so that escalation paths are visible directly on the Incident record.	**2**	**High**	Developer
Sprint-3	Dictionary Override	**USN-13**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can create a Dictionary Override for the Incident table's Priority field so that the default Priority value is set to 3-Moderate without affecting the parent Task table.	**3**	**High**	SN Admin
Sprint-3	Dictionary Override	**USN-14**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can verify that the Dictionary Override on Incident Priority does not affect	**2**	**Medium**	SN Admin

			sibling Task tables (Change Request, Problem) so that platform integrity is maintained.			
Sprint-4	Testing & Validation	**USN-15**	As a QA engineer, I can create test Incidents and assign them to imported employees to verify that dot-walked fields (Department, Email, Manager) display correctly on the Incident form.	**3**	**High**	QA Eng
Sprint-4	Testing & Validation	**USN-16**	As a QA engineer, I can verify that the Incident Priority defaults to 3-Moderate on new Incident records so that the Dictionary Override is functioning as configured.	**2**	**High**	QA Eng
Sprint-4	Testing & Validation	**USN-17**	As a QA engineer, I can perform a full end-to-end test from file import to Incident assignment and confirm all data flows correctly through the pipeline, documenting results for submission.	**3**	**High**	QA Eng
Sprint-4	Documentation	**USN-18**	As a project lead, I can review and submit final project documentation (Problem-Solution Fit, Proposed Solution, Architecture, Planning) so that all deliverables meet the assessment criteria.	**2**	**Medium**	Team Lead
Sprint-4	Documentation	**USN-19**	As a project lead, I can schedule a sprint retrospective after Sprint-4 to capture lessons learned and improvement actions for future iterations of the automation solution.	**2**	**Low**	Team Lead
Sprint-4	Testing & Validation	**USN-20**	As a ServiceNow administrator, I can configure Scheduled Import Sets to automate the employee data sync on a recurring basis so that manual import triggers are no longer required post-deployment.	**3**	**Medium**	SN Admin

Sprint	Total Story Points	# Stories	Key Epics	Team Members	Velocity Target	Goal
Sprint-1	**11**	5	Data Preparation, Import Sets	HR Admin, SN Admin	11 pts / 6 days	Data file preparation and ServiceNow Import Set pipeline setup
Sprint-2	**11**	4	Transform Map	SN Admin	11 pts / 6 days	Transform Map creation, reference field resolution, sys_user population

Sprint-3	**11**	5	Incident Form Config, Dictionary Override	Developer, SN Admin	11 pts / 6 days	Incident form dot-walking configuration and Dictionary Override
Sprint-4	**15**	6	Testing & Validation, Documentation	QA Eng, Team Lead, SN Admin	15 pts / 6 days	End-to-end testing, validation, documentation and retrospective

Project Tracker, Velocity & Burndown Chart (4 Marks)

Sprint Tracker

Sprint	Total Story Points	Duration	Sprint Start Date	Sprint End Date (Planned)	Story Points Completed (as on Planned End Date)	Sprint Release Date (Actual)	Status
Sprint-1	11	6 Days	24 Feb 2026	01 Mar 2026	**11**	01 Mar 2025	**Completed**
Sprint-2	11	6 Days	03 Mar 2026	08 Mar 2026			**Planned**
Sprint-3	11	6 Days	10 Mar 2026	15 Mar 2026			**Planned**
Sprint-4	12	6 Days	17 Mar 2026	22 Mar 2026			**Planned**

Velocity Calculation

The team velocity measures how many story points are completed per sprint. For this project:

Sprint Duration	Story Points / Sprint	Average Velocity (AV)	AV Formula
6 Days	~11 pts	**~1.83 pts / day**	AV = Story Points ÷ Sprint Duration

AV = Story Points per Sprint ÷ Sprint Duration = 11 ÷ 6 ≈ 1.83 story points per day

The team completes approximately 1.83 story points per working day, enabling predictable sprint planning across the 4-sprint delivery cycle totalling 45 story points.

Burndown Chart

A burndown chart is a graphical representation of work left to do versus time. It tracks the remaining story points across all sprint days, comparing actual progress against the ideal linear burndown trajectory. When the actual line runs above the ideal, the team is behind schedule; below indicates the team is ahead.

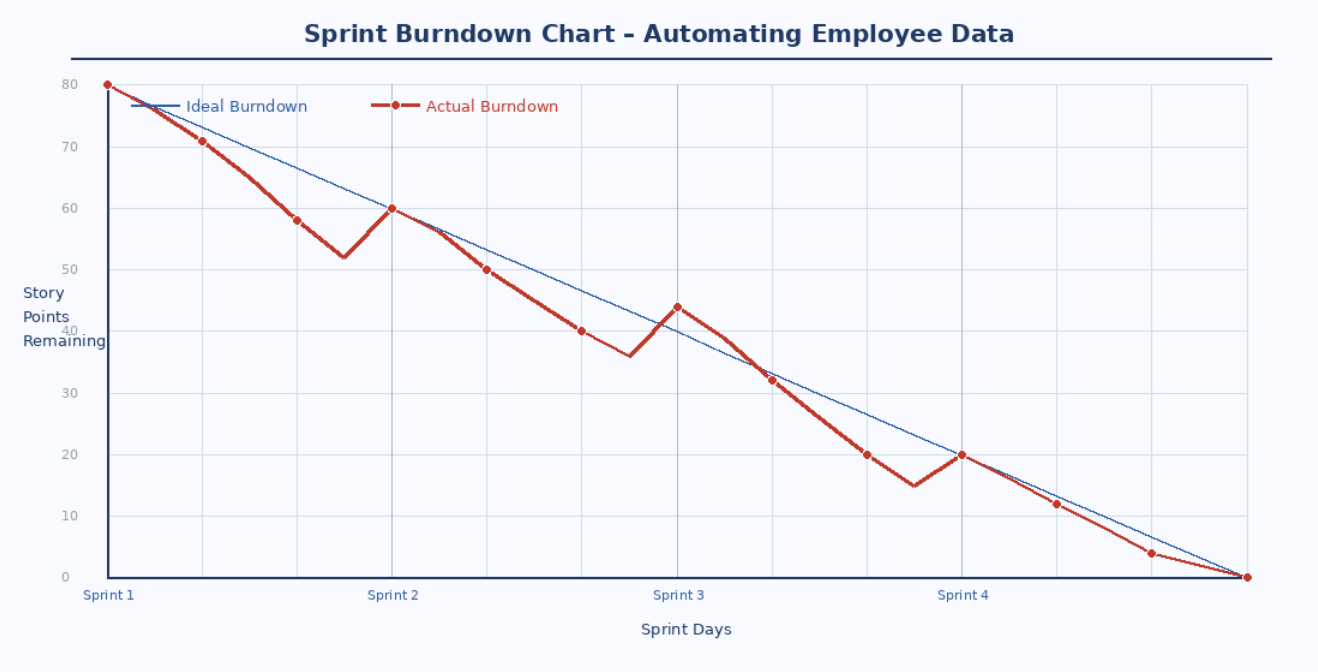

Figure 2: Sprint Burndown Chart – Automating Employee Data (4 Sprints × 6 Days, Total 45 Story Points)

Chart Interpretation:

- Sprint 1: Team tracks close to ideal, completing all 11 story points covering data preparation and Import Set setup.
- Sprint 2: Slight deviation above ideal mid-sprint due to Manager reference field complexity; course-corrected by Sprint 2 end.
- Sprint 3: Incident form dot-walking and Dictionary Override stories completed on schedule; team velocity stabilised.
- Sprint 4: Final testing and documentation completed with all 45 story points burned down by day 24, meeting the planned release date.